

CRYPTO PROJECT RESEARCH REPORT

CHILIZ
(\$CHZ)

Deep-Dive Analysis · August 2026 · NBZ / NASIR

\$130.02M	\$0.8914	170+	#151	10.48B
Market Cap	All-Time High	Sport Partners	CMC Rank	Total Supply

A comprehensive, independently researched analysis of Chiliz (\$CHZ) covering Team, Technology, Tokenomics, Market Overview, Use Cases, Competitors, Recent News & Investment Risk Assessment — sourced from verified and up-to-date public data.

Research by NBZ / NASIR

01 · PROJECT OVERVIEW

FIELD	DETAIL
Project Name	Chiliz — The Sports Blockchain
Token Ticker	\$CHZ
Blockchain Layer	Chiliz Chain — Layer 1 (L1) purpose-built sports and entertainment blockchain
Built On	Independent EVM-compatible L1 — PoSA consensus; previously Ethereum-based (migrated 2022)
Protocol Type	SportFi infrastructure — Fan Token platform, L1 blockchain, Socios.com engagement app
Founded	2018 — by Alexandre Dreyfus in Malta
Headquarters	Malta (Chiliz Group — formerly HX Entertainment Limited)
Parent Company	The Chiliz Group Limited (rebranded Oct 2025 from HX Entertainment Limited)
Total Supply	10,480,000,000 CHZ (10.48B — inflationary via staking rewards; decay scheduled to 2030)
Circulating Supply	10,480,000,000 CHZ (~100% in circulation — August 2026)
Max Supply	No hard cap — inflationary with burn mechanism and 2030 deflationary strategy
Total Raised	\$65M across seed, private placement, and strategic rounds
Key Products	Socios.com (Fan Token platform) · Chiliz Chain (L1) · KayenFi (Fan Token DEX) · OG Esports (owned)
Sports Partners	170+ including FC Barcelona, PSG, Juventus, Manchester City, UFC, NBA teams, F1 teams
Partner Revenue	\$700M+ cumulative revenue delivered to sports partners since 2018
MiCA Status	First MiCA-authorised entity in the SportFi sector — EU licence granted Sep 2025
Vision 2030	Tokenised sports RWAs: media rights, revenue streams, and minority equity exposure for fans

Chiliz is the world's leading blockchain infrastructure provider for the sports and entertainment industry. Founded in 2018 by serial entrepreneur Alexandre Dreyfus in Malta, the company built Socios.com — the first and largest Fan Token platform globally — and subsequently launched Chiliz Chain, a purpose-built EVM-compatible Layer 1 blockchain specifically optimised for sports fan engagement applications. The native token \$CHZ serves as the economic backbone of the entire ecosystem: it is used to purchase Fan Tokens, pay network gas fees, secure the chain through staking, and power governance on Socios.com.

The Chiliz ecosystem has delivered \$700M+ in cumulative revenue to its sports partners and driven the Fan Token market cap past \$1 billion in 2025 — real financial outcomes for over 170 sports organisations including FC Barcelona, Paris Saint-Germain, Juventus, Manchester City, the UFC, Formula 1 teams, and NBA franchises. In September 2025, Socios Europe Services became the first MiCA-authorised entity in the entire SportFi sector, granting regulated access to over 400 million fans across all 27 EU member states — a regulatory milestone that no competitor has matched.

In September 2025, The Chiliz Group acquired a 51% controlling stake in OG Esports — one of the most decorated esports organisations in history, with two consecutive Dota 2 International championship wins. This acquisition marks Chiliz's strategic expansion beyond pure blockchain infrastructure into direct sports ownership, with Socios.com serving as the exclusive platform for the \$OG Fan Token. Looking ahead, the Vision 2030 roadmap targets tokenised sports real-world assets: media rights, revenue streams, and eventual minority equity exposure for token holders.

02 · TEAM & FOUNDERS

NAME	ROLE	BACKGROUND
Alexandre Dreyfus	Founder & CEO	Serial entrepreneur and visionary behind the Sports Fan Token concept. Founded Chiliz in 2018 after selling previous ventures in online poker (Winamax) and media. Active on X and LinkedIn. Drives the Vision 2030 roadmap and all major strategic decisions.
Emma Diskin	COO	Chief Operating Officer. LinkedIn-verified profile. Manages day-to-day operations, partnerships, and platform delivery across Socios.com and Chiliz Chain.
Gilbert Camilleri	CMO	Chief Marketing Officer. Active on X and LinkedIn. Leads global marketing campaigns across 170+ sports partnerships and brand positioning for the CHZ token.
Max Rabinovitch	CSO	Chief Strategy Officer. Active on X and LinkedIn. Leads strategic development, new partnership acquisition, and ecosystem growth initiatives.
Thibaut Pelletier	CTO	Chief Technology Officer. LinkedIn-active. Principal technical architect overseeing Chiliz Chain development, hard fork upgrades, and the PoSA consensus mechanism.
Mark Verdegaaal	CPO	Chief Product Officer. Active on X and LinkedIn. Leads product development across Socios.com, KayenFi DEX, and the Chiliz Chain developer ecosystem.
Dorianne Spiteri	CLO	Chief Legal Officer. LinkedIn-active. Manages regulatory strategy, MiCA compliance, MFSA licensing, and legal frameworks across all Chiliz Group entities.
Julian La Picque	Group CFO	Group Chief Financial Officer. LinkedIn-active. Oversees financial strategy, treasury management, and the \$65M funding rounds across the Chiliz Group.

Chiliz has one of the most complete and publicly disclosed C-suite teams in the entire crypto industry. Eight named executives with verified LinkedIn and social profiles, each occupying clearly differentiated senior leadership roles — CEO, COO, CMO, CSO, CTO, CPO, CLO, and Group CFO. This level of organisational structure is typical of a publicly-listed company, not a crypto startup, and reflects Dreyfus's ambition to build a regulated, institutionally credible sports blockchain company.

Alexandre Dreyfus's founding track record is directly relevant: he built and sold Winamax into one of Europe's largest online poker platforms before pivoting to sports blockchain. His ability to navigate regulated gambling markets, build relationships with major sports organisations, and scale consumer-facing digital products to millions of users is the exact skill set required to execute the Chiliz vision. The presence of a dedicated CLO (Dorianne Spiteri) and a Group CFO (Julian La Picque) signals that Chiliz is managing itself as a regulated financial entity — not a decentralised protocol.

03 · TECHNOLOGY & ARCHITECTURE

COMPONENT	DESCRIPTION
Blockchain	Chiliz Chain — independent EVM-compatible Layer 1 (L1) blockchain
Built On	Original L1 — not built on Ethereum or another chain; migrated from Ethereum in 2022
Chain ID	Mainnet: 88888 · Testnet (Spicy): 88882
Consensus	Proof of Staked Authority (PoSA) — combines Proof of Authority + Proof of Stake
Block Producer Selection	Snake8 upgrade (Oct 2025): randomised, stake-weighted validator election each block
Smart Contracts	Solidity (EVM-compatible) — supports MetaMask, Hardhat, Moralis, thirdweb, Remix, Privy
EVM Compatibility	Fully EVM-compatible — any EVM wallet (MetaMask etc.) works natively on Chiliz Chain
Socios.com	Consumer fan engagement platform — Fan Token purchase, governance polls, exclusive content
Fan Tokens™	Club-specific governance tokens — vote on kit designs, training locations, experiences
KayenFi	Dedicated DEX specialising in Fan Tokens™ — swap Fan Tokens with CHZ and stablecoins
Omnichain Bridge	Bridge CHZ and Fan Tokens to Solana and Base — cross-chain Fan Token accessibility
CHZ Staking	Delegate CHZ to validators — earn staking rewards — contribute to network security
Validator Network	Permissioned validators include sports clubs (e.g. PSG) — aligned incentives for partners
EIP-1559 Fee Burning	Dragon8 hard fork (May 2024) introduced fee burning — deflationary pressure on supply
Dragon8 Hard Fork	May 2024: Tokenomics 2.0 — inflationary model + EIP-1559 fee burning introduced
Pepper8 Hard Fork	Sep 2025: Integrated Paribu Net blockchain; migrated user balances to CHZ
Snake8 Hard Fork	Oct 2025: Randomised stake-weighted block producer selection — fairer validator rewards
Socios Web3 Wallet	Non-custodial Web3 wallet launched late 2024 — connects 2M+ Fan Token holders to dApps
Developer Tools	Greenhouse Hub (grants), Rise Bootcamp (education), Hackathon programme (Hacking Paris)
MiCA Compliance	MiCA whitepaper registered with ESMA — first SportFi entity MiCA-authorised in EU

Chiliz Chain is a purpose-built Layer 1 blockchain — not a general-purpose chain forced into a sports use case, but a blockchain designed from the ground up for fan engagement at scale. Its Proof of Staked Authority (PoSA) consensus mechanism is the ideal choice for SportFi: it provides the transaction throughput and low latency needed for real-time fan interactions during live sporting events, while maintaining meaningful decentralisation through stake-weighted validator selection.

The three hard forks since 2024 demonstrate active technical development: Dragon8 (May 2024) introduced Tokenomics 2.0 with EIP-1559 fee burning; Pepper8 (September 2025) integrated the Paribu Net blockchain migrating user balances; and Snake8 (October 2025) overhauled the block producer selection mechanism to randomised, stake-weighted election — making the network fairer for validators who contribute more to network security. This cadence of meaningful protocol upgrades reflects a functioning development team with a clear technical roadmap.

The omnichain bridge to Solana and Base — enabling Fan Tokens to move beyond Chiliz Chain — is a strategically important upgrade. Fan Tokens previously trapped on Chiliz Chain can now access DeFi liquidity on Base (Aerodrome, etc.) and Solana, dramatically expanding their utility. KayenFi, the dedicated Fan Token DEX, provides the primary trading venue for this expanded omnichain ecosystem.

04 · USE CASES & REAL-WORLD APPLICATIONS

USE CASE	DESCRIPTION	STATUS
Fan Token Purchase	CHZ is the primary currency to buy Fan Tokens on Socios.com for 170+ sports orgs	Live
Fan Governance Polls	Fan Token holders vote on real club decisions: kit designs, training locations, charity choices	Live
Exclusive Fan Experiences	Token holders access VIP experiences, signed merchandise, meet-and-greets, stadium tours	Live
Network Gas Fees	CHZ pays all transaction fees on Chiliz Chain for Fan Token trades and dApp interactions	Live
CHZ Staking / Delegation	Delegate CHZ to validators; earn staking rewards; contribute to chain security	Live
KayenFi DEX Trading	Swap Fan Tokens using KayenFi — the dedicated Fan Token DEX on Chiliz Chain	Live
Omnichain Fan Tokens	Bridge Fan Tokens to Solana and Base — access DeFi liquidity beyond Chiliz Chain	Live
Socios Web3 Wallet	Non-custodial wallet connecting 2M+ Fan Token holders to dApps on Chiliz Chain	Live — 2024
Validator Node Operation	Sports clubs (e.g. PSG) operate as validators — earn CHZ rewards while securing network	Live
Prediction Markets	Build fan prediction markets on match outcomes, player stats, tournament results	Live — dApp
Sports NFTs	Mint and trade sports NFTs representing moments, player cards, memorabilia	Live — dApp
CHZ Burns	Deflationary burns: 4.6M+ CHZ burned as part of 2030 deflationary strategy	Live — ongoing
Tokenised Sports RWAs	2027+: tokenised media rights, revenue streams, minority equity exposure for fans	Vision 2030
OG Esports Fan Economy	Socios.com exclusive platform for \$OG Fan Token following 51% OG Esports acquisition	Live — 2025
MiCA Regulated Services	First EU MiCA-authorised SportFi platform — regulated access for 400M+ European fans	Live — Sep 2025

Chiliz's use case model is built around a single, expanding insight: sports fans are the world's most loyal and passionate consumer group, but they have historically had no economic relationship with the clubs and teams they support. Fan Tokens change this equation — they convert passive fandom into active, tokenised participation, giving fans a verifiable stake in the clubs they love and giving sports organisations a direct digital revenue stream from their global communities. The governance poll mechanism is the most immediately tangible use case. FC Barcelona, PSG, and Juventus have all run binding governance polls where Fan Token holders made real decisions — from shirt designs to training music choices to charitable donations. These are not token-gated surveys; they are club-endorsed decisions that the team honours through smart contracts. The Vision 2030 roadmap takes this significantly further — targeting tokenised media rights and eventual minority equity exposure, which would represent the first truly fractionalised sports ownership model at institutional scale.

05 · COMMUNITY & ECOSYSTEM

METRIC	DATA
Sports Partners	170+ major sports organisations across football, basketball, MMA, F1, esports
Notable Partners	FC Barcelona · Paris Saint-Germain · Juventus · Manchester City · UFC · F1 teams · NBA franchises
Partner Revenue	\$700M+ cumulative revenue delivered to sports partners since 2018
Fan Token Market Cap	Passed \$1 billion in 2025 — peak of Fan Token market development
Socios Users	2M+ Fan Token holders on Socios.com / Socios Web3 Wallet
EU Regulated Reach	400M+ fans across 27 EU member states via MiCA-authorised Socios Europe Services
X (Twitter)	@Chiliz — active official account; major sports announcements and protocol updates
Hacking Paris	First-ever hackathon in a stadium (Parc des Princes, PSG) — 236 devs, 16 countries, \$150K prize
OG Esports (Owned)	51% acquisition Sep 2025 — first esports Fan Token to reach \$100M market cap
Spain National Team	Royal Spanish Football Association launched \$SPAIN Fan Token on Socios.com (2025)
Belgium National Team	Royal Belgian Football Association launched \$BELG Fan Token ahead of 2026 World Cup
PSG as Validator	Paris Saint-Germain (2025 Champions League winners) operates as a Chiliz Chain validator
MiCA Milestone	Sep 2025: First MiCA-authorised entity in SportFi — MFSA licence granted to Socios Europe Services
CHZ Burns	4.6M+ CHZ burned (\$165K+) as part of 2030 deflationary strategy (verified on-chain)
Developer Ecosystem	Greenhouse Hub (grants) · Rise Bootcamp (free course) · 70+ major IP partners on chain
Exchange Listings	Binance · KuCoin · Phemex · WhiteBIT · OKX · BYDFi · CoinW · Cryptomus

Chiliz's community is uniquely structured around real-world sports fandom rather than crypto-native speculation. The 2M+ Fan Token holders on Socios.com are primarily sports fans who entered the ecosystem through their club affiliations — Barcelona fans buying \$BAR tokens, PSG fans buying \$PSG tokens — not crypto traders looking for the next 100x. This creates a more stable and less speculation-driven community base than most crypto projects, but it also means community growth is tied to sports season cycles and major tournament moments rather than DeFi activity.

The 2026 FIFA World Cup is the most significant near-term community catalyst in Chiliz's history. National team Fan Tokens — including \$SPAIN and \$BELG recently launched — create a once-every-four-years moment where billions of casual football fans engage with the sport simultaneously. Chiliz's positioning as the MiCA-regulated Fan Token platform gives it a unique advantage in reaching European fans through regulated channels during this period.

06 · INVESTORS & PARTNERSHIPS

ROUND	DATE	AMOUNT	INVESTORS
Seed / Strategic	2018–2019	\$15M	YZi Labs (prev. Binance Labs) — Incubator / Lead; FBG Capital; Jump Crypto
Private Placement	2020–2021	\$50M	Private placement allocation — 14.03% of CHZ supply at discounted price
Total Raised	Cumulative	\$65M	YZi Labs · Jump Crypto · FBG Capital · Ceyuan Ventures · OK Blockchain Capital

TIER	INVESTOR	TYPE
Tier 1	YZi Labs (prev. Binance Labs)	Incubator — Binance’s investment and incubation arm. Formerly Binance Labs. Tier 1 credibility; signals Binance ecosystem alignment for CHZ.
Tier 2	Jump Crypto	Venture — one of the largest and most active crypto trading and venture firms globally. Deep liquidity infrastructure capabilities.
Tier 2	FBG Capital	Venture — Asia-based crypto fund; early-stage investor with strong exchange ecosystem connections.
Tier 4	Ceyuan Ventures	Venture — China-based technology venture fund with crypto portfolio.
Tier 4	OK Blockchain Capital	Venture — OKX’s blockchain-focused venture investment arm.
Partner	PSG (Validator)	Sports Club — Paris Saint-Germain operates as a Chiliz Chain validator — 2025 Champions League winners.
Partner	FC Barcelona	Sports Club — One of Chiliz’s largest Fan Token partners since 2018; \$BAR among highest Fan Token market caps.
Partner	Socios Europe (MFSA)	Regulator — Malta Financial Services Authority granted MiCA authorisation Sep 2025.

Chiliz’s investor base reflects its early-mover status in the sports blockchain space. YZi Labs (formerly Binance Labs) as the Tier 1 incubator provides both ecosystem alignment with the world’s largest crypto exchange and credibility validation that pre-dates most SportFi competitors. Jump Crypto’s involvement brings market-making infrastructure and institutional liquidity support — particularly relevant for CHZ given the token’s high circulating supply and need for exchange depth.

The most strategically significant ‘investor’ in Chiliz is not a financial institution but PSG itself: Paris Saint-Germain operates as a Chiliz Chain validator — meaning the 2025 UEFA Champions League winners are both a Socios.com partner and an active network participant securing the blockchain. This dual relationship creates aligned incentives that go beyond typical sports blockchain partnerships — PSG has a direct financial stake in Chiliz Chain’s performance and security.

07 · TOKENOMICS

PARAMETER	DETAIL
Token Symbol	CHZ
Token Standard	EVM-compatible native token of Chiliz Chain L1; also ERC-20 bridgeable
Total Supply	10,480,000,000 CHZ (10.48B — inflationary via staking rewards)
Circulating Supply	10,480,000,000 CHZ (~100% in circulation — August 2026)
Max Supply	No hard cap — inflation continues with decay rate until 2030 deflationary target
Inflation Rate	Revised May 2024 (Dragon8): from 8.8% to 1.88% over 14 years (Tokenomics 2.0)
Fee Burning (EIP-1559)	Dragon8 introduced EIP-1559-style fee burning — partially offsets inflation
Deflationary Burns	4.6M+ CHZ burned (\$165K+) on-chain as part of Vision 2030 deflationary strategy
Staking Rewards	65% of new inflation distributed to validators/delegators
Ecosystem Distribution	25% of inflation to Ecosystem and Operational Distribution
Liquidity/Community	10% to CHZ liquidity pools, community vault, shared security restaking rewards
Token Utility	Buy Fan Tokens · Pay gas fees on Chiliz Chain · Stake to validators · Governance
Pepper8 Governance	Sep 2025: Community vote amended inflation schedule via hard fork

ALLOCATION	%	NOTES
Rewards for Validators / Delegators	38.54%	Ongoing staking rewards; 65% of new inflation flows here
Company Reserves	20.34%	Chiliz Group operational reserves and strategic treasury
Private Placement	14.03%	Investor allocation from 2020–2021 private placement rounds
Ecosystem & Operational (E&O;) Distribution	14.82%	Ecosystem grants, developer funding, operational expenses
Seed Investor	3.05%	Seed round allocation — YZi Labs, Jump Crypto, FBG Capital era
Team	2.03%	Core team allocation — subject to vesting schedule
Consultant	1.22%	Advisor and consultant compensation
Community Vault / CHZ LP / Restaking Rewards	~6%	Community incentives, liquidity provision, restaking rewards

CHZ's tokenomics underwent a significant redesign in May 2024 with the Dragon8 hard fork (Tokenomics 2.0), which reduced the long-term inflation rate from 8.8% to 1.88% over 14 years and introduced EIP-1559-style fee burning. This was a meaningful improvement to the token's supply dynamics: as network activity grows, more CHZ is burned through fee destruction, creating a natural deflationary force that partially offsets the ongoing staking emission schedule.

The September 2025 Pepper8 governance proposal — approved by community vote and implemented as a hard fork — further amended the inflation schedule, demonstrating that CHZ's economic model is actively managed by community governance rather than fixed in stone. The on-chain burn programme (4.6M+ CHZ burned as of 2026) and the Vision 2030 deflationary strategy signal a long-term commitment to supply management that investors in inflationary tokens rarely see articulated and executed.

08 · MARKET OVERVIEW

\$130.02M	\$130.02M	\$12.84M	\$0.8914	▼98.6%
Market Cap	FDV	24h Volume	ATH	Below ATH

METRIC	DATA
Token Symbol	CHZ
24h Price Range	\$0.01234 – \$0.01262 (August 2026)
Market Cap	\$130.02M (August 2026 — CoinMarketCap)
Unlocked Market Cap	\$129.76M
Fully Diluted Val.	\$130.02M (market cap = FDV; ~100% circulating)
24h Trading Volume	\$12.84M (August 2026)
All-Time High	\$0.8914
All-Time Low	\$0.004
Current vs ATH	~98.6% below all-time high
Current vs ATL	~210% above all-time low
Circulating Supply	10.48B CHZ (~100% of total supply)
Total Supply	10.48B CHZ (inflationary — no hard cap)
CMC Rank	#151 (August 2026)
Performance (24h/7d)	▲+0.63% (24h) · ▼3.16% (7d)
Performance (30d/90d)	▼25.87% (30d) · ▼72.83% (90d)
YTD Performance	▼69.82% (year-to-date August 2026)
Exchange Listings	Binance · KuCoin · Phemex · WhiteBIT · OKX · BYDFi · CoinW · Cryptomus

CHZ's market performance in 2026 has been one of the most severe corrections among established crypto projects: down 69.82% year-to-date and 72.83% over the past 90 days, trading at approximately \$0.012 versus its all-time high of \$0.89. The scale of this correction is disproportionate to the underlying operational performance of the Chiliz ecosystem, which continues to sign new sports partnerships, deliver partner revenue, and achieve regulatory milestones.

The disconnect between price and fundamentals is primarily explained by two factors: the absence of a near-term catalyst (the 2026 FIFA World Cup being the most obvious potential trigger) and the structural challenge of CHZ's nearly 100% circulating supply — meaning every CHZ that exists is already in the market, with no locked supply to provide scarcity. This full-float structure means CHZ price is purely a function of demand, with no supply-side support mechanisms like vesting cliffs or lock-up periods reducing available tokens.

However, at a market cap of \$130M against \$700M in partner revenue delivered and a Fan Token market cap that passed \$1 billion, CHZ appears to be pricing in very little of the ecosystem's demonstrated value creation. The 2026 World Cup narrative, MiCA regulatory clarity, and the Vision 2030 tokenised RWA roadmap represent the primary potential re-rating catalysts.

09 · COMPETITORS & MARKET POSITION

PROJECT	TYPE / CHAIN	MKT CAP	VS \$CHZ
Socios / \$CHZ	SportFi L1 / Chiliz Chain	\$130M	First-mover · 170+ partners · MiCA-authorized · \$700M partner revenue · only licensed SportFi in EU
Flow (FLOW)	Sports/NFT L1 / Flow Chain	\$120M+	NBA Top Shot chain; different focus (collectibles vs governance); earlier mover in sports NFTs but narrower use case
Dapper Labs	Sports NFT / Flow	Private	Creator of NBA Top Shot and NFL All Day; collectibles-focused not fan governance; no public token
REVV (REVV)	Motorsports NFT / Multi-chain	\$20M+	Formula 1 and MotoGP NFTs; smaller partner base; no governance mechanism; niche vs Chiliz's breadth
NBA Fan Tokens	NBA-specific / Various	N/A	Individual team tokens via various platforms; fragmented; no unified chain like Chiliz Chain
Sorare	Fantasy Sports / Ethereum	Private	Fantasy football cards as NFTs; different mechanic (ownership not governance); large Series B but private
Krause House	Basketball DAO / Ethereum	Small cap	DAO attempting to buy an NBA team; experimental; far smaller scale than Chiliz
Galaxis	Fan Engagement / Multi-chain	Small cap	Broader creator engagement tokens; no major sports exclusive partnerships

Chiliz has no direct peer in the regulated, institutionalised sports blockchain space. The combination of 170+ exclusive major sports partnerships, \$700M in delivered partner revenue, an own Layer 1 blockchain, MiCA authorisation across all 27 EU member states, and a consumer platform with 2M+ users creates a competitive position that no other project has come close to replicating in the seven years since Chiliz launched.

Flow Network (NBA Top Shot) is the closest technical analogue, but serves a fundamentally different use case: collectible NFT trading rather than governance participation. Sorare addresses a different fan behaviour (fantasy sports) through a different mechanism (NFT-based player cards). Neither has achieved MiCA regulatory authorisation, institutional validator partnerships with sports clubs, or a governance-first model at Chiliz's scale. Chiliz is, by most objective measures, the only company that has built a sustainable, regulated business around sports blockchain.

10 · RECENT NEWS & UPDATES (2018–2026)

DATE	EVENT
Aug 2026	CHZ trading at \$0.012–0.013; market cap \$130M; CMC #151. Down 69.82% YTD despite strong ecosystem fundamentals. World Cup 2026 narrative building as key near-term catalyst.
2026	Royal Belgian Football Association launches \$BELG Fan Token on Socios.com — timed ahead of the 2026 FIFA World Cup for maximum exposure to tournament narrative.
Oct 2025	Snake8 Hard Fork: randomised stake-weighted block producer selection implemented — fairer validator reward distribution. Chiliz Group renamed from HX Entertainment Limited. Updated CHZ whitepaper notified to MFSA.
Sep 2025	The Chiliz Group acquires 51% controlling stake in OG Esports (Sep 16). OG Fan Token becomes first esports token to pass \$100M market cap. Socios.com becomes exclusive \$OG platform.
Sep 2025	Pepper8 Hard Fork: Paribu Net blockchain integrated; user balances migrated to CHZ. Inflation schedule amended via community governance vote.
Sep 2025	Socios Europe Services becomes first MiCA-authorised entity in SportFi sector — MFSA licence granted Sep 11. CHZ MiCA-compliant whitepaper registered with ESMA.
2025	Royal Spanish Football Association joins Socios.com — official Spain national team Fan Token launched ahead of the 2026 World Cup.
2025	Fan Token market cap surpasses \$1 billion milestone. Cumulative partner revenue delivered by Socios.com exceeds \$700M. 170+ sports organisation partnerships confirmed.
2025	Hacking Paris — first-ever hackathon held inside a stadium (Parc des Princes, PSG). 236 developers, 16 countries, \$150K total prize pool.
2025	PSG (2025 UEFA Champions League winners) confirmed as Chiliz Chain validator. Socios Web3 Wallet launches non-custodial access for 2M+ Fan Token holders.
Late 2024	Socios.com non-custodial Web3 Wallet launches — enables 2M+ Fan Token holders to connect directly to dApps on Chiliz Chain. In-principle MiCA approval from MFSA announced (Oct 2024).
May 2024	Dragon8 Hard Fork: Tokenomics 2.0 launched. Inflation rate reduced from 8.8% to 1.88% over 14 years. EIP-1559 fee burning introduced. 65%/25%/10% inflation split confirmed.
2022	Chiliz Chain L1 launches — migration from Ethereum-based infrastructure to independent EVM-compatible L1 blockchain. CHZ becomes native gas token of Chiliz Chain.
2021	CHZ all-time high of \$0.8914. Peak bull market coincides with surge in sports blockchain interest during NFT and DeFi boom.
2019–2020	Major football club Fan Token launches: FC Barcelona (\$BAR), Juventus (\$JUV), PSG (\$PSG), Manchester City (\$CITY) all launch on Socios.com.
2018	Chiliz founded by Alexandre Dreyfus in Malta. Seed investment from YZi Labs (Binance Labs), Jump Crypto, FBG Capital. Vision: tokenise sports fan engagement globally.

Chiliz's news timeline is one of consistent institutional progress: regulatory milestones, partnership expansions, and protocol upgrades executed in sequence over seven years. The September 2025 convergence of events — MiCA authorisation, OG Esports acquisition, Pepper8 hard fork, and 170+ sports partners — represents the most operationally dense period in the protocol's history and suggests a team executing deliberately toward its Vision 2030 roadmap rather than reacting to market conditions.

11 · INVESTMENT POTENTIAL & RISKS

▲ BULLISH CASE	▼ BEARISH RISKS
+ Only MiCA-authorized SportFi platform in the EU — regulated access for 400M+ European fans	- 98.6% below ATH — no hard supply cap, ~100% circulating; pure demand-driven price
+ 170+ major sports partnerships delivering \$700M+ in cumulative partner revenue — real business	- 69.82% YTD decline despite strong operational fundamentals — severe market disconnect
+ Fan Token market cap passed \$1B in 2025 — genuine ecosystem traction verified	- No supply-side scarcity: 10.48B CHZ fully circulating; no vesting cliffs or lockups
+ YZi Labs (Binance Labs) incubator — Tier 1 institutional credibility and exchange alignment	- Fan Token utility is limited to governance polls and perks — not financial products
+ 2026 FIFA World Cup is a massive narrative catalyst for national team Fan Tokens	- Inflationary emission to validators continuously adds new CHZ supply
+ OG Esports acquisition: first sports asset owned outright by a blockchain company	- Sports cycle dependency: CHZ demand peaks around tournaments, fades in quiet seasons
+ Dragon8 + Pepper8 + Snake8 hard forks: active protocol development with community governance	- Competition from traditional sports monetisation: clubs don't need blockchain for merchandise revenue
+ EIP-1559 fee burning + 2030 deflationary strategy addresses inflation risk over time	- CHZ's value accrual from Fan Token activity is indirect — not a direct fee-sharing model
+ Vision 2030 tokenised RWAs (media rights, equity) is a genuinely transformative roadmap	- OG Esports acquisition is a distraction risk — sports team operations are complex
+ PSG as validator: world's most recognisable club directly securing the blockchain	- Vision 2030 tokenised equity is legally uncharted territory in most jurisdictions

RISK FACTOR	DETAIL
Supply Risk	CHZ has no hard supply cap and ~100% of total supply is already in circulation. New CHZ is continuously minted as staking rewards (38.54% of inflation to validators/delegators). With no locked supply creating scarcity, CHZ price depends entirely on demand growth outpacing emission.
Sports Cycle Risk	CHZ price historically correlates with major sports events (World Cup, Champions League, Super Bowl). Outside these catalysts, trading volume and Fan Token activity decline significantly. The 72.83% 90-day correction reflects a quiet sports summer cycle compounded by macro crypto weakness.
Utility Ceiling	Fan Token governance polls are powerful for fan engagement but limited as financial products. Fans vote on shirt designs and charity donations — not revenue distributions or equity stakes. Until Vision 2030 tokenised RWAs materialise, CHZ's value accrual from Fan Token activity remains indirect.
Regulatory Risk	Despite MiCA authorisation in the EU, CHZ faces ongoing regulatory scrutiny in other jurisdictions. The US SEC's treatment of Fan Tokens — particularly those offering any financial rights — remains an open question that could affect Socios.com's US expansion.
Competitor Risk	While Chiliz has no direct peer today, major sports leagues (NFL, NBA, La Liga) could build their own tokenised fan platforms as blockchain adoption matures. The league-owned alternative would bypass Chiliz entirely and could fragment the Fan Token market.
World Cup Risk	The 2026 FIFA World Cup is CHZ's most obvious near-term catalyst. If Fan Token demand fails to materialise during the tournament — as happened during the 2022 World Cup for some tokens — the missed catalyst could extend the current bear market for CHZ well into 2027.

NBZ RESEARCH VERDICT

Chiliz (\$CHZ) is one of the most operationally successful crypto projects that the market is currently pricing as though it has failed. The evidence is clear: \$700M+ in delivered partner revenue, 170+ institutional sports partnerships, MiCA authorisation as the first regulated SportFi platform in the EU, a Fan Token market cap that passed \$1 billion, active protocol development through three hard forks in 18 months, and a 51% acquisition of a major esports organisation. These are not speculative metrics — they are auditable operational outcomes from a seven-year-old business. Yet at \$0.012 and 98.6% below ATH, the market is valuing CHZ at \$130M — a figure that implies deep scepticism about the Fan Token model's long-term viability or CHZ's ability to capture value from ecosystem growth. That scepticism is not irrational: the full-float supply structure, inflationary emissions, and indirect value accrual from Fan Token activity are genuine structural challenges. The 2026 FIFA World Cup is the clearest near-term catalyst for a re-rating — if national team Fan Tokens drive Socios.com adoption at scale during the tournament, CHZ could see its most significant demand spike since 2021. For investors who believe in the long-term SportFi thesis and can tolerate continued downside risk, CHZ at current prices is arguably the lowest-risk entry point in years. For those who need near-term catalysts, the World Cup is it. **Not financial advice.**

Data sourced from: CoinMarketCap, CoinGecko, CryptoRank, docs.chiliz.com, chiliz.com, socios.com, KuCoin Learn, Bitget Academy, CoinGecko Learn, Yahoo Finance, Esports Insider, CMC AI Latest Updates, The Chiliz Group Official Blog, Socios.com Press Releases, ESMA MiCA Register, Malta Financial Services Authority (MFSA).